

Assessment Helper — Kickoff Meeting Notes

Date: September 4, 2026

Attendees: Prof. Priya Narayanasami (Faculty Advisor) + Project Team

What We're Building

A **workflow and scheduling management system for faculty evaluations** — it manages who needs to be observed, matches available observers, tracks the process, and gives the Assessment Committee (AC) visibility into everything.

Platform & Tech Stack

- Build a desktop application.
- Extending it to a web app is a bonus (not required, but a nice stretch).
- Tech stack: **our choice**, as long as everything is free / open source (no paid tools, no 30-day trials).

MVP Scope

- The **"Primary Objectives"** section from the project slides = our MVP.
- Everything in the "Stretch Goals" section of the slides is lower priority — attempt only if time allows.

Who Uses the System (End Users)

- Professors and AC (Assessment Committee) members.
- We should create dummy/sample professor accounts for testing and demo purposes.

How Evaluations Work

Evaluation Frequency by Rank

Professor Rank	Observation Frequency
Assistant Professor	At least once a year
Associate Professor	Once every 2 years
Full Professor	Once every 2 years

Sign-Up & Access Rules

- Professors sign up for a course each semester and get access to the observations tied to that course.
- A professor can receive observations from another professor (e.g., Professor A observes Professor B) — both professors involved need visibility into that record.
- Professors can sign up for multiple evaluations per semester, potentially across different topics/subjects.
- The software should let professors see:
 - The evaluations they've given
 - The evaluations they've received
 - Who gave/received each one (attribution matters)

Evaluation Form

- We can build an online form for the evaluation itself.
- The professor conducting the observation may either:
 - Use our built-in form, or
 - Upload their own form/document

The Matching Process (Important — Read Carefully)

This is NOT a fully automated assignment system. Here's the actual flow:

1. Our software generates a list of professors who are due for evaluation.
2. From that list, our system surfaces ~5 potential observer professors within the same project area/course who have signed up and are available.
3. Those 5 professors can then decide among themselves if they're willing/able to do the evaluation.
4. We do not auto-finalize who observes whom — that's a human decision.
5. Our software sends the generated list to the AC, not directly to professors.
6. The AC reviews and approves before anything goes out.
7. Only after AC approval does an email go out to professors (with reminders as needed).
8. We are never automatically sending emails/notifications ourselves — the AC is always the approval step in between.

Edge Case: New Hires

- If a new hire professor needs an evaluation and no one in their subject area is available, an AC member may step in to do the evaluation themselves.

KPIs (Key Performance Indicators)

- The KPIs listed in the project slides double as a guide for what features/metrics matter most — treat them as a checklist for what our dashboards and reports should surface.

Meeting Cadence & Logistics

- **Weekly reports:** due most likely on Fridays (confirm exact day/time with Prof. Narayanasami).
- **In-person meetings:** once or twice for the whole semester, depending on the TA's schedule — otherwise virtual.

Open Questions / Follow-Ups

Add anything still unclear here as we go — e.g., exact weekly report format, TA contact info, in-person meeting dates once scheduled.